



Data breaches are so common these days, with trillions of dollars on the line, that the ever-growing list of high-profile victims includes major corporations (Target, CVS), restaurant chains (Wendy's, Panera), financial firms (Citigroup, Equifax), universities (UC Berkeley, Johns Hopkins), social media sites (Facebook, LinkedIn), secretive governmental agencies (NSA, IRS), and more.

The average cost of a data breach is at \$3.86 million, according to IBM's 2020 Cost of a Data Breach Report. Of course, such computations are an inexact science.

The average cost of a breach can range from \$1.25 million to \$8.19 million, according to 77-page research from Digital Guardian, which looked at incidents reported by 507 organisations from 17 industries and 16 countries around the world.

The US ranks first in terms of average cost per data breach (\$8.19 million in 2019, up from \$7.91 million in 2018).

Health care, financial services, and energy are among the industries that have been struck the worst.

Demand for Ethical Hackers

It's easy to see why the demand for cybersecurity specialists in general,